

Crupellarius (meaning unknown)

The *crupellarius*, a type of gladiator from Gaul, was completely covered in metal plate armor, like a medieval knight. A *crupellarius* was slow moving but hard to wound or kill.

Dimachaerus ("holding two knives")

The *dimachaerus* was a skilled fighter who fought with a sword or knife in both hands.

Eques ("horse rider")

Fought on horseback with a 6-ft (2-m) lance and a sword. An *eques* carried a round shield and wore a tunic and a helmet. The mounted gladiator's lower legs and sword arm were guarded by wrappings, and for a fair fight, it was always a fight between a pair of *equites*.

Essedarius ("war-chariot fighter")

Fought from a lightweight, two-wheeled war chariot, like the warriors Julius Caesar fought in Britain. As in British chariot warfare, there may have been two people in each vehicle: a fighter armed with spears and a driver.

Gallus ("Gaul")

An early type of gladiator, the *gallus* was a heavily armored fighter who had a long, slashing sword, like the warriors of Gaul, and a large shield. After Gaul became part of the Roman Empire, the *gallus* fell out of fashion.

Hoplomachus ("shield-fighter")

One of the most heavily armored fighters, these gladiators wore greaves (metal leg guards) to protect

their lower legs and covered their right arm and thighs with padded fabric wrappings. A *hoplomachus* wore a helmet to protect their head and face, carried a tiny round shield, and fought with a lance as well as a short sword.

Laquerarius ("noose-fighter")

Fought with a lasso in one hand and a sword in the other.

Myrmillo ("fish")

The name *myrmillo* came from the fighter's big helmet which, in early years, had a distinctive fish crest. *Myrmillones* carried a sword and a large shield, and although they had a bare chest, their sword arm and legs were protected with fabric wrappings. Their usual opponents were the *thraex* or *hoplomachus*.

Paegniarius ("comic fighter")

A clown whose job was to entertain the audience with mock fights during intervals. *Paegniarii* wore no armor and fought each other with whips or wooden swords.

Provocator ("challenger")

Was armed like an early Roman legionary, with a large rectangular shield and a short straight-edged sword. These fighters had a greave on their left leg, a helmet with a visor and two feathers, and an arm guard on their sword arm. The *provocator* was the only gladiator to wear a breastplate.

Retiarius ("net-fighter")

A lightly armed, fast-moving fighter who did not wear a helmet. *Retiarii* fought with a net, a three-pronged